Bodo Cultural Heritage: Eri Silk & Traditional Weaving

Category: CRAFT | Region: Assam | Status: needs_check

Bibliographic Citation & Provenance:

The Kacháris (Sidney Endle, 1911); Bodoland Sericulture and Handloom Department

Narrative & Cultural Documentation:

Eri silk (Endi) and handloom weaving are central pillars of Bodo material culture and economic self-reliance. Historically, rearing the Eri silkworm (Sam or Philosamia ricini), which feeds primarily on castor leaves (Ricinus communis), was carried out in almost every Bodo household. Eri silk is known as "Ahimsa silk" or peace silk because the moths naturally emerge from the open-ended cocoon, allowing the thread to be hand-spun without boiling live pupae. Traditional Bodo women weave durable, warm Eri shawls (Endi Chadar) and cloth on indigenous looms (Taat-Xal / Sal). Traditionally, a young woman's competence in weaving intricate patterns (Agor) was regarded as one of her most admired virtues.